

Cybersecurity Daily Newsletter

Vol. 004 | 2026-08-08 09:00 WIB

Top 5 Highlights

- Living off the coding agent: Two tales of tunnels and LaunchAgents
- Forcepoint's Ronan Murphy on securing the data layer AI just set on fire
- Fortra's Josh Davies on the evolving exploitation of trust
- AI chat bots are sliding into League of Legends friend requests
- Metabase SQLi zero-day exploited in customer data-theft attacks

Threat Intelligence (10)

01. Living off the coding agent: Two tales of tunnels and LaunchAgents

Agent-parented reverse tunnels and LaunchAgents can expose a local admin app to the internet. Endpoint still needs to treat that as high severity even when the activity looks like vibe-coded ops, not confirmed malware.

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.elastic.co/security-labs/coding-agent-launchagent-tunnel-detection>

02. Vishing group UNC6671 now focuses on extorting M&A firms

Experts urge managed-device logins and audit log monitoring to stop phishing-led cloud data theft.

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Tighten email authentication and filtering, run targeted user awareness, and monitor for lookalike domains and suspicious inbox rules.

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/news/vishing-group-unc6671-now-focuses-on-extorting-ma-firms>

03. Nearly 800 Malicious npm Packages Deliver Cross-Platform RAT and Infostealer

A cluster of nearly 800 malicious packages has been published to the npm registry as part of a new campaign designed to deliver cross-platform malware targeting Windows, Mac, and Linux systems. "These packages appear to use AI slop squatted, or randomly generated typo-squatting package names, but all of them deliver a powerful RAT and infostealer payload,"...

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/08/nearly-800-malicious-npm-packages.html>

04. ClickFix Attacks Deliver macOS Stealer That Can Drain Crypto Wallets

ClickFix-style attacks are being used to deliver a Go-based malware capable of stealing cryptocurrency assets, as well as browser-stored passwords, Apple iCloud Keychain data, and cached credentials. The macOS-focused infection chain is designed to deliver a shell script that profiles the host and then fetches a macOS malware payload that's compatible with...

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/08/clickfix-attacks-deliver-macos-stealer.html>

05. Trojanized AI skills gain 1.7M installs in agent-targeted attack

Researchers have uncovered an extremely effective attack campaign that involved AI agent skills trojanized to deploy a credential stealer. The incident is part of a growing trend in which attackers are targeting the AI software supply chain by poisoning sharable instruction and configuration files for agentic tools. Discovered by researchers from security f...

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Audit build pipelines, rotate CI/CD secrets, enforce package integrity controls, and review developer workstation hardening.

Sources: <https://www.csoononline.com/article/4206851/trojanized-ai-skills-gain-1-7m-installs-in-agent-targeted-attack.html>

06. Zbtlink denies backdoor claims amid firmware download pause

VulnCheck CTO Jacob Baines claims that Zbtlink routers are intentionally designed to communicate with command and control servers, a feature he calls a "phone-home trojan horse."

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/brief/zbtlink-denies-backdoor-claims-amid-firmware-download-pause>

07. In Other News: AI Slop Limits Apple Bounties, North Carolina Port Attacks, Hackers Target Wall Street

Noteworthy stories that might have slipped under the radar: ban on Chinese data center tech, QuickFox VPN supply chain attack, IEH Corporation mailbox breached via phishing. The post In Other News: AI Slop Limits Apple Bounties, North Carolina Port Attacks, Hackers Target Wall Street appeared first on SecurityWeek .

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Audit build pipelines, rotate CI/CD secrets, enforce package integrity controls, and review developer workstation hardening.

Sources: <https://www.securityweek.com/in-other-news-ai-slop-limits-apple-bounties-north-carolina-port-attacks-hackers-target-wall-street/>

08. Real emails, hijacked payments: Two H1 2026 attack chains

Gen's H1 2026 Threat Report examines two separate attack chains. One used compromised business inboxes and browser manipulation in a banking-malware campaign, while the other used clipboard hijacking to redirect cryptocurrency payments.

[...]

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/real-emails-hijacked-payments-two-h1-2026-attack-chains/>

09. The Good, the Bad and the Ugly in Cybersecurity - Week 32

Snowflake hacker's guilty plea covers a 100M-record breach, Mythos 5 spends 34 hours trying to backdoor real code, and ChainDrop's worm spreads via npm.

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.sentinelone.com/blog/the-good-the-bad-and-the-ugly-in-cybersecurity-week-32-8/>

10. Microsoft 365 AitM Phishing Hijacks Accounts to Collect Payroll and Finance Emails

Cybersecurity researchers have called attention to an active "widespread email-driven phishing campaign" that employs adversary-in-the-middle (AitM) techniques to take control of Microsoft 365 accounts with an aim to identify key personnel involved in financial workflows and gather related email. "The campaign uses residential proxies to disguise malicious...

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Tighten email authentication and filtering, run targeted user awareness, and monitor for lookalike domains and suspicious inbox rules.

Sources: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/08/microsoft-365-aitm-phishing-hijacks.html>

Latest Vulnerabilities (10)

01. Forcepoint's Ronan Murphy on securing the data layer AI just set on fire Murphy on why data trust is the foundation of the agentic era.

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/resource/forcepoints-ronan-murphy-on-securing-the-data-layer-ai-just-set-on-fire>

02. Fortra's Josh Davies on the evolving exploitation of trust

Davies shares insights from original FIRE research, while also digging into trends.

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/resource/fortras-josh-davies-on-the-evolving-exploitation-of-trust>

03. Metabase SQLi zero-day exploited in customer data-theft attacks

A critical Metabase SQL injection vulnerability was exploited in zero-day attacks to breach customer instances in data theft attacks, known to impact Framework and Tally. [...]

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/framework-tally-disclose-metabase-data-theft-attacks/>

04. Researchers bypass Spectre v2 mitigations

The attack exploits a time-of-neutralization to time-of-use (TONTOU) window in Spectre v2 defenses, where a gap exists between when the branch predictor is isolated and when it is used.

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources:

<https://www.scworld.com/brief/researchers-bypass-spectre-v2-mitigations-leak-data-from-linux-machines>

05. AI-Generated Patches Fail Half the Time

A study of more than 6,000 patches found that even working patches can introduce new bugs, break something else, or are open to bypass.

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.darkreading.com/application-security/ai-generated-patches-fail-half-time>

06. N-able God mode flaw: Vendor confirms attackers reached customer networks as second hotfix lands

Attackers turned admin access into a route downstream, while N-able tells N-central customers to patch - again

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.theregister.com/networks/2026/08/07/n-able-god-mode-flaw-vendor-confirms-attackers-reached-customer-networks-as-second-hotfix-lands/5284730>

07. Moonshot's Kimi AI model has also escaped from a test environment

Yet another AI model has escaped from a cybersecurity test lab: This time, it's the Chinese company Moonshot's Kimi K3 model on the run. Frontier Security spotted that Kimi K3 had found a loophole in the UK AI Safety Institute's test environment for AI models performing cybersecurity tasks. The news follows similar exploits by models from OpenAI, which atte...

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.csoonline.com/article/4206782/moonshots-kimi-ai-model-has-also-escaped-from-a-test-environment.html>

08. VU#987105: The nothings stb TrueType library, up to version 1.26, contains a heap buffer overflow vulnerability

Overview A heap buffer overflow vulnerability exists in the stb TrueType library created by nothings. Exploitation of this vulnerability can occur when handling malformed font data and may lead to both Denial of Service (DoS) and Information Disclosure. Description The nothings stb repository, versions 1.26 and earlier, contains a collection of single-file...

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://kb.cert.org/vuls/id/987105>

09. MIT boffins' TONTOU attack slips through Spectre defenses on Intel and AMD CPUs

Timer interrupts reopen branch predictor poisoning window, with a working Zen 2 exploit to prove it

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.theregister.com/security/2026/08/07/mit-boffins-tontou-attack-slips-through-spectre-defenses-on-intel-and-amd-cpus/5284081>

10. New WordPress Pre-Auth XSS Could Lead to PHP Code Execution - Patch ASAP

WordPress has fixed a pre-authentication reflected cross-site scripting (XSS) flaw in its login screen that affects every version of the content management system. pwn.ai demonstrated how the flaw can be chained into PHP code execution on the server when a logged-in administrator interacts with an attacker-controlled page. Tracked as CVE-2026-64638 (CVSS sc...

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/08/new-wordpress-pre-auth-xss-could-lead.html>

Data Breach & Cybercrime (10)

01. AI chat bots are sliding into League of Legends friend requests

Chat bots are sending friend requests in Riot immediately after ending your game. What are the scammers up to now?

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.malwarebytes.com/blog/ai/2026/08/ai-chat-bots-are-sliding-into-league-of-legends-friend-requests>

02. Unlimited Technology Systems breach impacts 3.8 million people

Healthcare software company Unlimited Technology Systems reported that more than 3.8 million people were impacted by a data breach incident that occurred in October 2025. [...]

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/unlimited-technology-systems-breach-impacts-38-million-people/>

03. UNC6671 Vishing Attacks Target Personal Phones to Steal SaaS Data

A recent wave of cyber attacks targeting financial services, private equity, and professional services is attributed to a data extortion group known as UNC6671.

"UNC6671 continues to rely on voice phishing (vishing) to target enterprise employees, posing as IT help desk staff facilitating mandatory, urgent security migrations. Significantly, the threat acto...

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/08/unc6671-vishing-attacks-target-personal.html>

04. Ransomware attacks spike as world distracted by AI

What, you didn't think the top gangs were busy watching agents escape their sandboxes too, did you?

Why it matters: Ransomware operations combine disruption with extortion, making recovery speed and data-resilience core business risks.

Recommendation: Verify offline backups, test restores, harden remote access, and review segmentation to limit lateral movement.

Sources: <https://www.theregister.com/security/2026/08/07/ransomware-attacks-spike-as-world-distracted-by-ai/5284934>

05. Scot NHS trust probes access to medical records of 9-year-old girl after man arrested on suspicion of murder

Investigation into whether staff improperly accessed Minnie Merriman's file after she was named for the first time this week

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.theregister.com/security/2026/08/07/nhs-tayside-investigates-breach-concerning-data-of-dead-girl/5284815>

06. Snowflake attacker pleads guilty to hack of 165 companies' data

A Canadian hacker has admitted being part of a group responsible for several major cyberattacks. Connor Riley Moucka pleaded guilty to being part of a coterie of hackers that hit 165 organizations, resulting in the theft of customer records and the extortion of millions of dollars. Industry sources have identified Moucka as one of the main players in attack...

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.csoonline.com/article/4206739/snowflake-attacker-pleads-guilty-to-hack-of-165-companies-data.html>

07. Vishing Extortion Group UNC6671 Rebrands After Making Millions

Initially calling itself BlackFile, the group has expanded operations to the Redact, Pink, Helix, and Falcon brands. The post Vishing Extortion Group UNC6671 Rebrands After Making Millions appeared first on SecurityWeek .

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources:

<https://www.securityweek.com/vishing-extortion-group-unc6671-rebrands-after-making-millions/>

08. [+24h Old] Google Links Redact Extortion Group to BlackFile Rebrand

BlackFile has rebranded as Redact after an alleged affiliate hijack, with Google linking the group to ongoing vishing and extortion campaigns

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.infosecurity-magazine.com/news/redact-extortion-group-blackfile/>

09. [+24h Old] What does a data breach cost? AI is a sizable factor

The financial impact of a data breach is substantial for any modern business, regardless of industry or size. IBM's latest Cost of a Data Breach report discovered that, from March 2025 to February 2026, the average cost of a data breach rose to \$6 million, up 35% from \$4.44 million a year earlier. The 2026 report, conducted by Ponemon Institute and sponsore...

Why it matters: Ransomware operations combine disruption with extortion, making recovery speed and data-resilience core business risks.

Recommendation: Verify offline backups, test restores, harden remote access, and review segmentation to limit lateral movement.

Sources: <https://www.csoonline.com/article/567697/what-is-the-cost-of-a-data-breach-3.html>

10. [+24h Old] Ransomware Surges in July After Q2 Lull

Finance, technology and healthcare sectors were particularly heavily targeted in July, according to Comparitech

Why it matters: Ransomware operations combine disruption with extortion, making recovery speed and data-resilience core business risks.

Recommendation: Verify offline backups, test restores, harden remote access, and review segmentation to limit lateral movement.

Sources: <https://www.infosecurity-magazine.com/news/ransomware-surges-july-q2-lull/>